Proposal for Emoji: DRAGONFLY; DAMSELFLY

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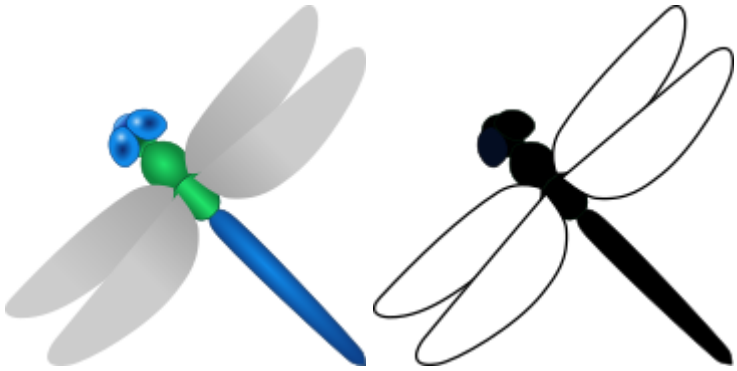
1. Identification

CLDR short name: dragonfly

CLDR keywords: insect, dragonfly, damselfly, bug

2. Images

180px: 

72px:

18px:

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3. Sort Location

Category: animal-bug

Ordering: the DRAGONFLY emoji should come after the SNAIL emoji and before the BUTTERFLY emoji, as dragonflies are among the most ancient insects in their evolutionary history.

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5. Selection factor – Inclusion

A. Compatibility

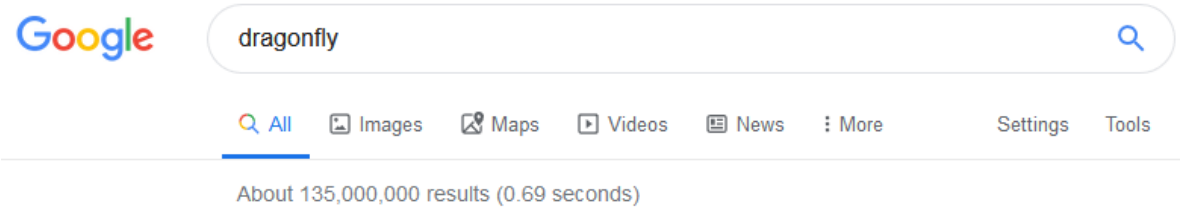
N/A

B. Expected usage levels

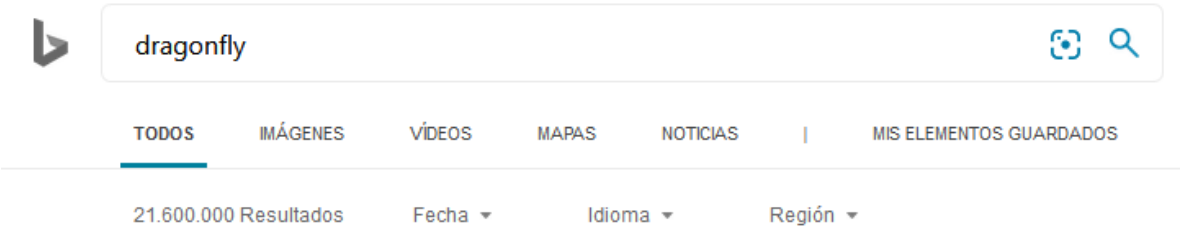
1. Frequency

In the Web Search results for both Google and Bing the term DRAGONFLY display more than a million result (even in the Google Video Search), with more than a hundred million for Google Web Search. When seeing trends, there are clear spikes during summer (when adult dragonflies are more abundant around the world). The search trends for DRAGONFLY generally surpasses the search for the term HONEY BEE, which is a charismatic insect species that has been the center of the news lately due to their populations' decline **[1]**.

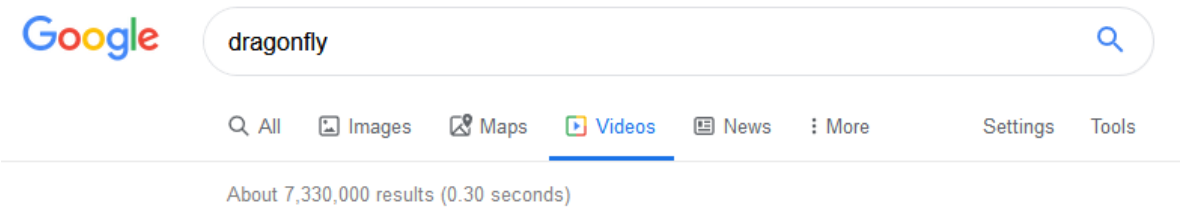
Google Search



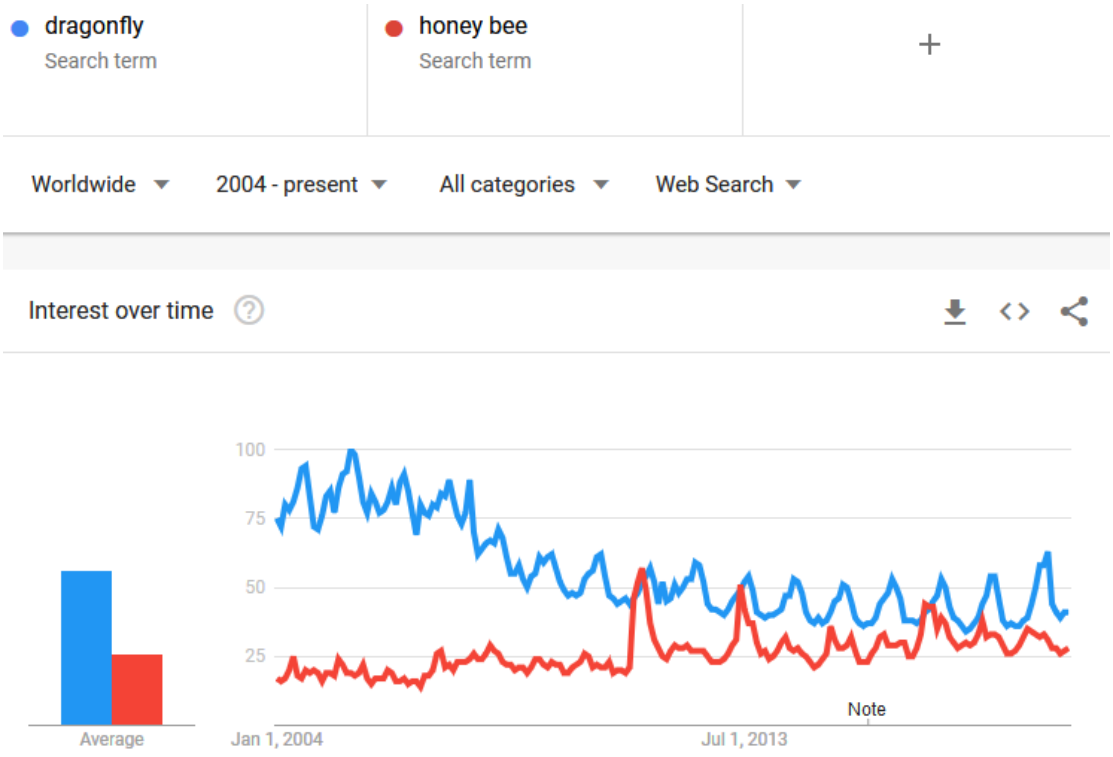
Bing Search



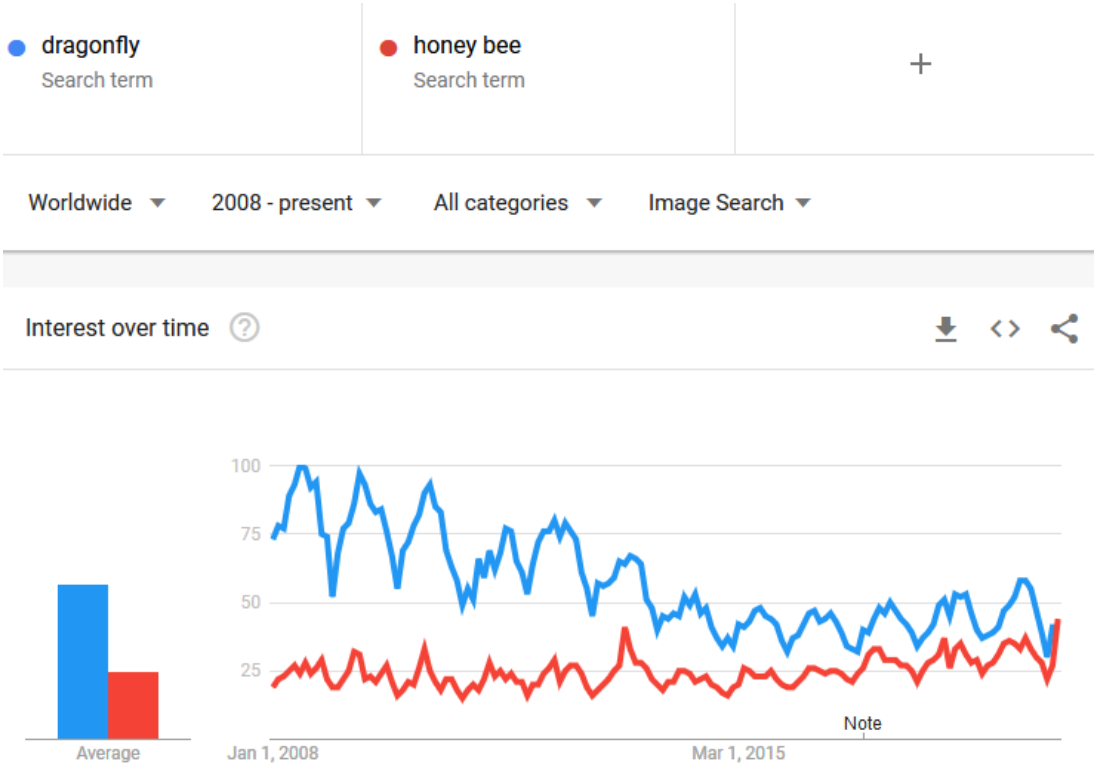
Google Video Search



Google Trends: Web Search



Google Trends: Image Search



2. Multiple usages

The DRAGONFLY emoji could be used interchangeably to represent both DRAGONFLY and DAMSELFLY, as they belong to the same insect group and share similar features. The interpretation of the DRAGONFLY image can vary between cultures. In Native American ethnicities the DRAGONFLY is seen as a transmitter of omens and knowledge **[2]**, such as purity of water **[3]**. In Oriental cultures, such as the Japanese, it symbolizes seasonality, courage, strength and happiness **[3]**. In many cultures around the world, mainly in America and Asia, the DRAGONFLY has also been considered human food **[4]**. In European cultures, however, the DRAGONFLY is seen in a more negative light, which can be noticed with common names in English such as "Darner" **[4]**. They have been often represented in art, jewelry, and most recently DRAGONFLY watching has become popular, mainly within birdwatchers **[5]**.

3. Use in sequences

They can be used in multiple sequences, such as sequences about animals or insects, those representing changes (metamorphosis) or related to water.

4. Breaking new ground

The cultural impact of DRAGONFLY cannot be represented by any other existing emoji (See "Multiple usages").

C. Distinctiveness

The general shape of DRAGONFLY is easily distinguishable by being a slender and winged insect and can be easily recognized no matter how simple or complex its shape is illustrated.

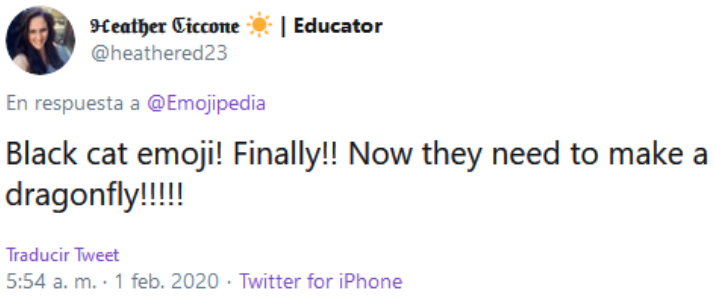
D. Completeness

The DRAGONFLY emoji would not only add to the representation of insects in emoji, but it would also complement the cultural representation of a charismatic and impactful insect group.

6. Selection factor – Exclusion

A. Petitions or "frequent requests"

With the recent announcement of the Emoji 13.0 release in 2020, the request of the DRAGONFLY emoji has spiked as a response **[7]**. Some examples:



Via https://twitter.com/heathered23/status/1223575379786588165

Via https://twitter.com/Astro_Limno/status/1222677993912291329

Via https://twitter.com/Holly_Kundel/status/1223075388282298369

B. Overly specific

The DRAGONFLY emoji is not overly specific as it represents a whole insect group (including damselflies) and has multiple cultural interpretations (See "Multiple usages").

C. Open-ended

The DRAGONFLY emoji represents a whole insect group that is present all around the world and has had great cultural and artistic impact (See “Multiple Usages”).

D. Already representable

Although there may be other insect emoji, no other emoji can represent the cultural connotations of DRAGONFLY.

E. Logos, brands, UI icons, signage, specific people, specific landmarks, deities

The DRAGONFLY emoji is not related to any logo, brand, UI icon, signage, specific people, specific landmark, or deities.

F. Transient

The use of the DRAGONFLY emoji would not be transient, as it is evident with the Google Trends results (See “Expected usage levels”).

G. Faulty comparison

The DRAGONFLY emoji is not proposed as on the basis of compatibility with other emoji.

H. Exact Images

The DRAGONFLY emoji does not need and exact image of a DRAGONFLY or DAMSELFLY, as they can be easily represented and recognized.

References

1. Jacobo, Julia. 2019. "Nearly 40% decline in honey bee population last winter 'unsustainable,' experts say". ABC News. Last accessed Feb 05, 2020 at https://abcnews.go.com/US/40-decline-honey-bee-population-winter-unsustainable-experts/story?id=64191609
2. "Opata people" Last accessed Feb 05, 2020 at https://enacademic.com/dic.nsf/enwiki/816218
3. Mitchell, Forrest L.; Lasswell, James L. (2005). A Dazzle of Dragonflies. College Station, TX: Texas A&M University Press.
4. Corbet, P. S. 1999. Dragonflies: behaviour and ecology of Odonata. Colchester, UK: Harley Books.
5. Adams, Jill U. 2012. "Chasing Dragonflies and Damselflies". Audubon Magazine. Last accessed Feb 05, 2020 at https://www.audubon.org/magazine/july-august-2012/chasing-dragonflies-and-damselflies
6. Twitter search "DRAGONFLY EMOJI". Last accessed Feb 05, 2020 at https://twitter.com/search?q=dragonfly%20emoji&src=typed_query